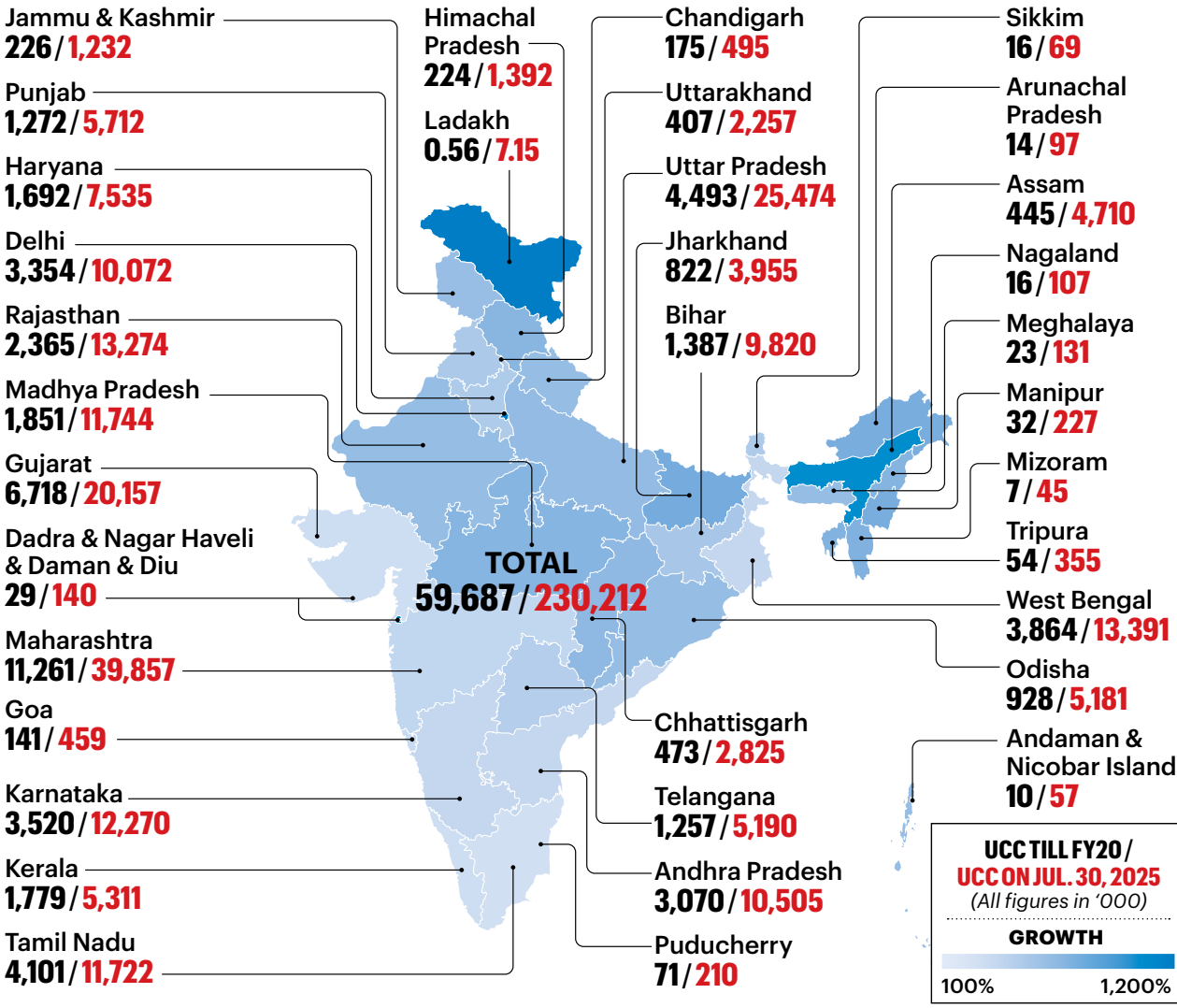
NEW BULLS, NEW TURF

A surge in NSE investor accounts shows more Indians are entering the stock markets—with significant growth coming from places like Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh and the Northeast, far from the traditional trading hubs of Mumbai and Delhi



55
PER CENT
Share of Tier 2/3 cities in new demat accounts

28
YEARS
Average age of the new investor

24
PER CENT
Women's share in new accounts

Note: An investor may maintain accounts with different brokers, resulting in multiple unique client codes (UCC). For instance, by the end of FY25, the total number of investor accounts (UCCs) registered with NSE surpassed 220 million, but the total number of unique investors stood at only 113 million; Source: NSE

the combined ownership of individual investors and mutual funds rose from 15.8 per cent to 19.9 per cent of the total market capitalisation of companies listed on the NSE. In the same period, the share held by FPIs fell from 21 per cent to 17.5 per cent. It shows how the balance of power in India's capital markets is steadily shifting into domestic hands.

THE DRIVING FORCE

The groundwork for India's retail investment surge was laid through a series of targeted policy and regulatory reforms. As early as 2010, NSE and BSE began partnering with telecom and tech firms to enable real-time trading access via mobile phones. In 2015, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), the market regulator, accelerated this shift by requiring brokerages to adopt a digital-first approach and serve non-institutional investors. Crucially, it introduced KYC norms and two-factor authentication—safeguards that built trust and encouraged new entrants.